

DAVIDE DANTONIO

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Innovation Economy operator sourcing, advising, and providing hands-on guidance for startups across 10 accelerator cohorts in the United States and Europe.

Work Authorization: United States, Europe, United Kingdom · Open to relocation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

GENER8TOR, Venture Capital Firm & Startup Accelerator

Indianapolis, IN

Director of Accelerator Programs: SaaS, AI, Web3 / Industry 4.0 / AgBioScience / Skyward (Aerospace) January 2023 to Present

- Built and coached a portfolio of 44 Midwest pre-Seed startups, enrolling them into a 2-month intensive acceleration program, by sourcing a 600+ founder pipeline through in-person activations, university tech-transfer partnerships, educational seminars, outreach automation, and due diligence selection on business viability, financial health, and scaling potential.
- Guided my portfolio startups to collectively raise \$7.84M and create 220 US jobs by introducing each founder to 30+ investors, building each founder's growth roadmap across the investment lifecycle, and planning milestone-based round structures to prove product-market fit and ROI to investors.
- Won \$1M+ NSF non-dilutive funding for Covert Defense (University-affiliated venture in cybersecurity), and \$1.2M Indiana tax credits for rScan (early-stage startup in supply-chain), by co-authoring NSF SBIR commercialization strategies (revenue model, market sizing, cash-flow projections, customer validation, sales discovery) and brokering State connections for the tax-incentive.
- Drove commercial traction, taking rScan from \$720K to \$1.8M, lifting Therapprove from free pilots to \$125K ARR, building XPERA a \$500K pipeline, and by designing multi-channel customer engagement funnels (inbound newsletters and content marketing, outbound outreach to ideal-client profiles and mutual connections) and running a 7-week sales-discovery challenge on cold-calling, objection-handling, and ROI-focused case studies and collateral.
- Led the launch of the first gBETA Skyward Italy: Aerospace & Advanced Manufacturing, commissioned by the Italian Region of Emilia-Romagna and co-funded by the European Union, advising 8 Italian startups and bringing 4 into US operations.
- Drove the US-market entry of three international startups, Feenix (MediaTech), ITER IDEA (resource-planning tech), and Vertikal X (SportsTech), by introducing their founders to American commercial and investment partners and state-level Economic Development Corporations: Vertikal X relocated operations to Indiana, Feenix Group secured its first US institutional investors, and ITER IDEA found commercial partners and closed a Seed round after entering the US.
- Grew the accelerator network to 200+ investors and 300+ mentors by leading 80+ speed-networking sessions and community meetups, and by supporting 20+ Entrepreneurship Support Organizations and venture partners across the ecosystem.

AMAZON PAY, Payment-Gateway Service

Luxembourg

Account Management Intern, FR/IT/ES region

February 2021 to July 2021

- Exceeded sales targets by 140% as top Q2 performer, increasing transaction volume by \$1.3M through Amazon Pay Express Checkout across a 20+ client e-commerce portfolio, and preventing \$2.5M in projected revenue loss through 7 client win-backs.

KRAFT HEINZ COMPANY

Amsterdam, Netherlands

Procurement Intern, Ingredients Team (EMEA region)

August 2020 to January 2021

- Identified \$200K in savings by optimizing the purchasing strategy for additives across 2,500 recipes, setting up 40+ supply contracts through 3 tenders, and supporting negotiations with 150+ suppliers.

MAMMA FLORA, Food Startup

London, United Kingdom (remote)

Marketing & Business Development Intern

May 2020 to July 2020

- Cut website bounce rate below 50% with a 4-day user-experience rebuild (Shopify to Squarespace) and grew qualified leads 15% in one month; closed 5 European distribution partnerships worth \$50K.

ENTREPRENEURSHIP AND ADVISORY

- Selected to judge 10+ startup competitions, present 15+ workshops, and advise founders in 10+ mentoring sessions for venture capital (Village Capital), university venture arms (Purdue Research Foundation), federal programs (National Science Foundation I-Corps, Akron and Purdue), and state initiatives (STARTedUP Foundation).
- Co-Founder: Young Outcasts Podcast (2024), interviewing 10+ guests across 20+ hours on resilience and reinvention in life and business; EarOnAir wellbeing platform (2022), leading a peer team to a minimum viable product, customer discovery with 50+ stakeholders, and sales conversations; and LushTech micro-mobility startup (2020), securing \$25K through incubation programs.
- Advisory: Vice-President of Platform, Born Global (2025), leading the Founders' Roundtable and Venture Lab; Advisory Council, McNair Institute, University of South Carolina (2022 to 2023), mentoring 100+ student founders; and Growth Analyst, Build It Up student consulting (2020), shipping a CO₂-offset plugin used by 800+ users.

EDUCATION

- University of South Carolina: Master of International Business and Business Analytics (full-tuition merit scholarship; GPA 3.9/4.0; Post-Baccalaureate STEM Certificate in Business Analytics), 2021 to 2022.
- ESCP Business School (Madrid & London): Master in Management, dual degree with Universidad Carlos III, 2019 to 2022
- Bocconi University (Milan): Bachelor's in Business Administration (GPA 3.7/4.0), with Exchange Semester in China, 2016 to 2019.

SKILLS

Venture finance & risk diligence: valuation (comparables, discounted cash flow), cash-flow scenarios, capital structuring (dilutive and non-dilutive), market sizing, and risk evaluation (financial, operational, and reputational).

Sales & Business Development: Salesforce, HubSpot, Sales Navigator, Apollo, Clay, Airtable; sales-qualification (MEDDPIC, SPIN)

Languages: Italian (C2 native), English (C2), Spanish (B1), German (A2).

Passions: Dancing (Salsa, Bachata, WCS), Sailing, Hot Yoga, Mentoring ([My Workshops](#)), Self-Discovery ([Young Outcasts Podcast](#))